



Where Matrix began—the first team

The newly introduced computer science programme had only twenty students. Ten were from the Gujarat board, and ten had joined through an all-India entrance route, most of whom came from English-medium backgrounds. Among the Gujarat board students, only a few had studied in English-medium schools, leaving about five or six, including Ganesh, from Gujarati-medium schools.

Ganesh credits much of his growth to the company he kept during those formative years. He was fortunate to have a group of sincere and academically focused friends in his hostel. While hostels often offer many distractions and diverse peer groups, his circle consisted of career-oriented, committed students. Their influence encouraged him to read more and strengthen his language skills.

In his first semester, however, he failed two subjects, mainly due to language difficulties. When professors delivered lectures in English, Gujarati-medium students often struggled to understand the terminology. In the evenings, Ganesh and his friends would return to the hostel and study using English-to-Gujarati dictionaries, translating unfamiliar words to understand their textbooks.

He recalls a small yet telling incident from those days. “While

preparing engineering drawing sheets, we were required to write our name, class, and roll number in the corner. I did not know the correct spelling and ended up writing ‘rall number’ instead of ‘roll number’. One of my friends noticed the mistake and corrected me. That moment clearly reflected how new and unfamiliar the language environment was for me.”

Despite these difficulties, Ganesh persisted. By his second year, he had begun to understand lectures more comfortably, though expressing himself was still challenging. During a class on the Fortran programming language, his professor, Dr R.C. Desai, noticed his hesitation while answering a question. Recognising the language barrier, the professor offered practical advice. He suggested that Ganesh start reading English newspapers regularly, especially *The Times of India*, to build familiarity with the language.

Ganesh took the advice seriously. In the hostel, he and his friends began reading newspapers and books regularly. Over time, this habit significantly improved his comprehension and communication skills in English.

The challenges of language, academic pressure, and adaptation often led to moments of frustration. Ganesh admits there were times

when the pressure brought him to tears. However, the thought of giving up never crossed his mind. Ganesh sees resilience as central to his approach to challenges. Looking back at his early academic struggles, including failing two subjects in his first semester due to language barriers, he reflects that difficulties and setbacks are a natural part of life. For him, challenges were never reasons to stop but opportunities to keep moving forward.

From engineering to entrepreneurship

Ganesh completed a Bachelor of Engineering in computer science from the Faculty of Technology and Engineering at The Maharaja Sayajirao University of Vadodara. For years after graduation, his focus was on starting a business. However, with time, he realised that running an organisation required knowledge beyond engineering, in areas such as finance, human resources, marketing, and management.

“To deepen my understanding of these areas, I later enrolled in a four-month residential Management Development Programme (MDP) at the Indian Institute of Management Ahmedabad. Aimed at mid-level professionals and entrepreneurs, the programme provided an overview of subjects covered in a full-time MBA. While it was not a degree course, the experience offered valuable exposure to core management concepts as well as the teaching approach at IIM,” explains Ganesh.

He considers the programme highly beneficial for understanding the broader dimensions of running and managing a business.

While exploring ways to start a business, Ganesh accompanied his friends to a few government job interviews, primarily for exposure and learning. Interestingly, he was selected twice but chose to decline the offers. He also received